

**TABLE II**  
**Functions of Context Menu**

| Menu             | Function                                                                              |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Copy ...         | Copies a process, group or a connection                                               |
| Edit → Paste ... | Pastes the processes at the system level, groups and connections at the process level |
| Diagram → Save   | Exports the diagram as a PNG or SVG image                                             |
| Diagram → Print  | Prints the diagram                                                                    |

Diagram editing toolbar(3) consists of functions like zooming in/out, adding a new process, a new group and new connection buttons.

Panner(4) is to navigate through the large diagrams and change the visible section of the diagrams.

Splitter(5) splits the diagram into separate views. From left to right: you can split vertically, horizontally, or revert to a single window view.

Browser(6) gives the option to directly access the elements of the system. The top node is for the system level, second is for processes and the third for groups. Double-clicking on any node opens the corresponding diagram. Right-clicking on the node opens the context menu.

Context menu has the following functions (refer Table II).

Main toolbar(7) consists of options for creating a new system, opening an existing system, saving the system and running the simulation.

Filter(8) can be used to search for elements directly in the browser.

**3. Creating a new system.** To create a new system, select *File→New System* via the menu or shortcut button from the main toolbar(7).

**4. Opening an existing system.** An existing file system is opened by selecting *File→Open* via the menu or shortcut button from the main toolbar(7).

**5. Saving the system.** Press the shortcut button on the main toolbar(7) or select *File→Save System* via the menu. To save it by a new name, select *File→Save System As* via the menu.

**6. Creating a new process.** To add a new process to the system, first ac-

tivate the system level by clicking on the leftmost tab in (2) or double clicking on the system node in browser(6), and then click on the new process button in diagram editing toolbar(3). The cursor will change and left clicking in the diagram editing plane will put the new process. Right clicking in free space will abort the action.

#### 7. Creating a new group.

To add a new group to a process, first activate a process by clicking on the corresponding tab in (2), or double clicking on the process node in browser(6) and then clicking on the new group button in diagram editing toolbar(3). The cursor will change and left clicking in the diagram editing plane will put the new group. Right clicking in free space will abort the action.

**8. Creating a new connection.** To add a new connection, click on the corresponding button in (3). The red arrow will create an excitatory connection, the green arrow will create a modulatory connection and the blue arrow will create an inhibitory connection. To position any connection, first click on the edge of the source and target group icons. Group icons are yellow squares.

**TABLE III**  
**Shortcuts and Icons**

| Menu                                                                              | Function/Description                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| File → New System                                                                 | Creates a new system                |
|  | Creates a new system (shortcut)     |
| File → Open                                                                       | Opens an existing system            |
|  | Opens an existing system (shortcut) |
| File → Save System                                                                | Saves the system                    |
| File → Save System As                                                             | Saves the system by a new name      |
|  | Saves the system (shortcut)         |
|  | Adds a new process (shortcut)       |
|  | Cursor after new process initiated  |
|  | Adds a new group (shortcut)         |
|  | Cursor after new group initiated    |
|  | New connection (red arrow)          |
|  | New connection (green arrow)        |
|  | New connection (blue arrow)         |
|  | Represents a connection             |
|  | Represents a process                |
|  | Represents a group                  |
|  | Split vertical                      |
|  | Split horizontal                    |
|  | Return to single window view        |
|  | Play/Run simulation                 |
|  | Stop simulation                     |

For creating connections among groups of different processes, first split the diagram editing pane into two views by using the Split Vertical and Split Horizontal buttons in (5). Then use (2) to display each separate view of the diagram editing pane of one of the processes containing the group you want to connect to. Finally, connect the two groups by the process described above. Return to the single-window view.

**9. Simulating the system.** To simulate, click on the Play button on the main toolbar(7). A warning will pop up if there is some inconsistency in the model. This can occur if any connection target is not defined.

To stop the simulation, press the Play button again. ●

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